PRIMO – The Well Plugging Optimizer

PRIMO is a **free and open-source** software decision-support tool developed by the Department of Energy's National Energy Technology Laboratory (NETL) to optimize well plugging projects by:

MODULAR CAPABILITIES

1. identifying **high-priority** wells
2. designing **efficient** and **impactful** well plugging projects
3. comparing competing well plugging projects **quantitatively**

HOW IT WORKS

1. Users provide data on wells (e.g., depth), site (e.g., population density) characteristics, and program provisions (e.g., budget)
2. Users specify priorities for ranking wells (e.g., production volumes) and "ideal" plugging projects (e.g., number of wells per project)
3. PRIMO executes a rigorous, optimization-based routine to return specific recommendations of ideal well candidates for high-impact, high-efficiency well plugging projects

DATA INPUTS

1. Plug in Data
- Well data/records
- GIS data/shapefiles/layers
- Plugging and equipment resources
- Well plugging budget

PRIMO CUSTOMIZATION WITH USER INPUTS

2. Specify User Preferences for

a. Ranking Wells
- Proximity to urban areas
- Well Age
- Production volumes

b. "Ideal" P&A Projects
- Large number of (high priority) wells
- Similar-characteristic wells (e.g., depth)
- Accessible well sites (e.g., distance to roads)

PRIMO RESULTS

3. Get Recommendations
- Well candidates based on priorities
- High-impact, high-efficiency plugging projects (w/scores)

PRIMO supports **data-based, transparent, and defensible** well selection and plugging decisions. There are no license fees or software use restrictions.

NETL is prepared and eager to assist stakeholders interested in PRIMO to optimize well plugging activities. For support and/or questions, contact PRIMO@netl.doe.gov.

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